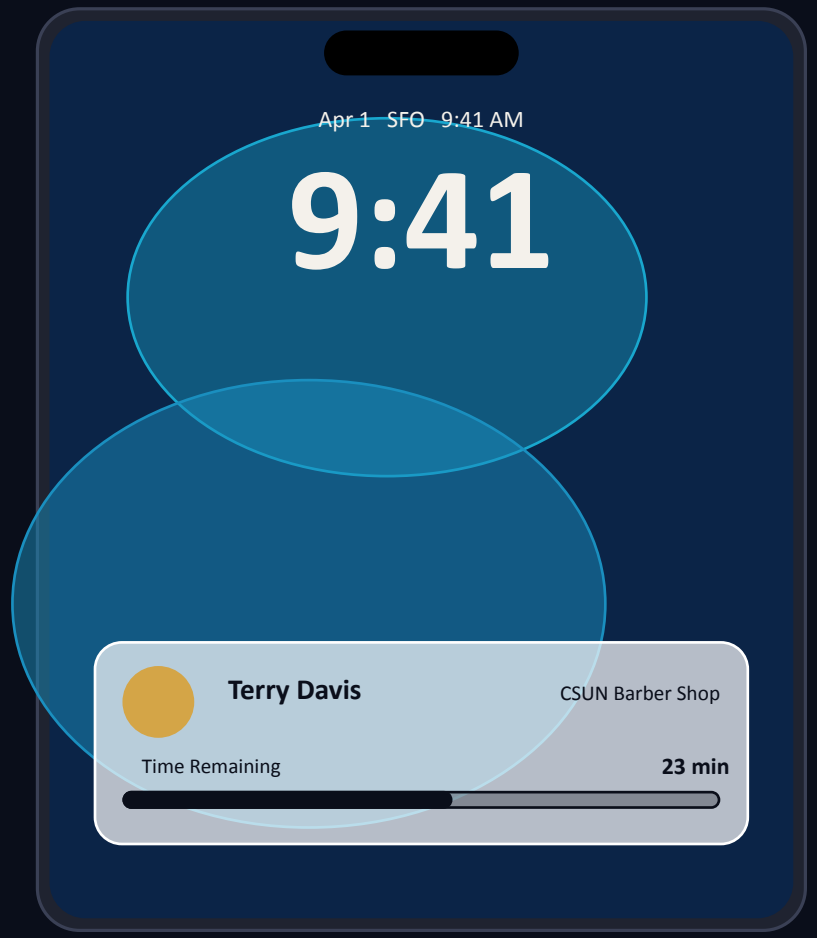
CutQ

BARBER MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

Reducing wait, building trust, on every chair.



HCI FINAL PRESENTATION

Group 8 · Jerry Ttuyan & Behrouz Barati B
Instructor: Armineh Karamian · Spring 2026

ROADMAP

Where we'll go in the next 15 minutes

01 **The problem** — Pain points on both sides of the chair

02 **Users & goals** — Personas, scenarios, jobs to be done

03 **Requirements** — What CutQ must do and what it must feel like

04 **Emotional design** — Reducing anxiety and cognitive load

05 **Barriers & solutions** — Accessibility, usability, cognition

06 **The product** — Wireframes, hi-fi UI, signature feature

07 **Usability testing** — What we learned and changed

08 **Conclusion** — Outcomes vs. success criteria

SYSTEM CONCEPT

What is CutQ?

A Jackrabbit-inspired program management platform — applied to barber shops.

> *CutQ centralizes scheduling, customer management, billing, and live time-awareness for small service-based programs, starting with barber shops, where wasted slots and missed appointments are everyday losses.*

Designed to reduce errors, build trust between barbers and clients, and lower the cognitive load of running and using a busy shop.

Centralize

One source of truth for every chair.

Communicate

Real-time status visible to all parties.

Recover

Alternative options when plans break.

THE PROBLEM

Two sides of the chair, both losing.

~10%
of small-shop time slots left unfilled per week

Booksy's *2025 State of the Barbering Industry*

10 min
average late arrival on walk-up bookings

ScienceDirect, 2021

1 in 3
clients leave when their barber is double-booked

American Salon poll

B From the barber's chair

- Clients arriving late chains delays through the whole day
- No-shows leave wasted, unrecoverable time slots
- Hard to keep mental track of "who's next" mid-service

C From the client's pocket

- Preferred barber fully booked and no easy alternative
- Last-minute booking uncertainty ("is anyone free now?")
- No clarity on where to go when their barber is unavailable

TARGET USERS

Three personas, three user spaces.

M

Marcus

Master Barber

PRIMARY USER

"Don't make me look at the wall clock between cuts."

Top anxieties

- Running late on chained appointments
- Losing tip-rich slots to no-shows

J

Jordan

Customer / Client

PRIMARY USER

"Tell me exactly when to leave the house."

Top anxieties

- Showing up late and losing the slot
- No backup when preferred barber is full

A

Andrea

Shop Owner / Admin

PROGRAM ADMIN

"Show me earnings and gaps without a spreadsheet."

Top anxieties

- Empty chairs, missed billing
- Trust between barbers and clients

FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

What the system must do.

Ten capabilities mapped from the assignment brief.

01 Authentication
Sign-up, sign-in, password recovery, secure sessions

02 Role-based Access
Customer, Barber, Shop Admin scopes with least-privilege

03 Customer Management
Profiles, contact info, preferences, history

04 Programs & Classes
Service offerings: cuts, beard trims, packages

05 Roster Management
Barber assignments, capacity, working hours

06 Billing & Invoices
Itemized charges, recurring packages, refunds

07 Payments & Receipts
Tokenized payments — never raw card data

08 Reporting Dashboards
Earnings, utilization, no-show rate

09 Notifications
Reminders, confirmations, Live Activity countdown

10 Activity Log
Audit trail for bookings, edits, refunds, role changes

NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

How the system must behave.

Accessibility

WCAG 2.1 AA

- 4.5:1 contrast on all body text (verified per surface)
- 44×44pt minimum tap targets across all controls
- VoiceOver/TalkBack labels on every interactive element
- Honors Dynamic Type and OS-level reduce-motion

Performance

SCALES CONCEPTUALLY

- Booking screens render in < 1s on mid-tier devices
- Server pagination on rosters and history (no all-at-once loads)
- Optimistic UI for booking confirmation; reconcile on error
- Live Activity updates batched to preserve battery

Security & Privacy

NO RAW PAYMENT STORAGE

- Stripe-style tokenization — card data never hits our DB
- Role-scoped APIs, server-enforced authorization
- PII minimized; logs scrubbed of identifying detail
- TLS 1.2+, hashed credentials, rate-limited auth

Designing for how it feels, not just what it does.

EMOTIONAL / PHYSICAL RISK	HOW CUTQ RESPONDS	WHY IT WORKS
Anxiety: "Will my slot disappear?"	Live countdown + booking confirmation receipt + Live Activity widget	Replaces uncertainty with a visible, persistent state.
Trust: "Did the booking really go through?"	Confirmation, large success state, calendar-style details card	Closes feedback loops the user can see and re-check.
Cognitive load: "Too many choices, too many steps"	Progressive disclosure — pick barber → pick time → confirm	One decision per screen; never more than 7 visible options.
Physical comfort: "I can't read this in the chair"	Dark theme by default, 16pt+ body, 44pt tap targets, no thin strokes	Readable at arm's length, in low salon light, on greasy fingers.

Accessibility, usability, and cognitive walls.

Accessibility

Barriers

- Low-vision users in dim shops
- Motor-impaired reach for small targets
- Screen reader users miss icon-only labels

Solutions

✓ Dark mode + 4.5:1 minimum contrast
✓ 44×44pt taps; thumb-reach bottom nav
✓ All icons ship with explicit accessible labels

Usability

Barriers

- Bookings made in error / wrong time
- Unclear what state an action is in
- Cancel-by-accident permanently

Solutions

✓ Confirmation screen before commit
✓ Persistent status pills ("In Progress")
✓ Undo within 5s; soft-delete with audit log

Cognitive

Barriers

- Too many choices on one screen
- Unfamiliar barbers feel risky
- Math: "how long until I should leave?"

Solutions

✓ Progressive disclosure — one decision/screen
✓ Ratings + reviews + tier surfaced upfront
✓ Live countdown removes the math entirely

UX PROCESS

Fourteen weeks, six phases.

Research, design, test, repeat.

1 — WKS 1–3
Research
Interviews
Field visits

2 — WKS 4–5
Define
Personas
Journey maps

3 — WKS 6–7
Sketch
Storyboards
Paper mockups

4 — WKS 8–9
Wireframe
Lo-fi flows
T-prototype

5 — WKS 10–11
Hi-fi UI
Figma screens
Design system

6 — WKS 12–14
Test & iterate
Usability tests
Final polish

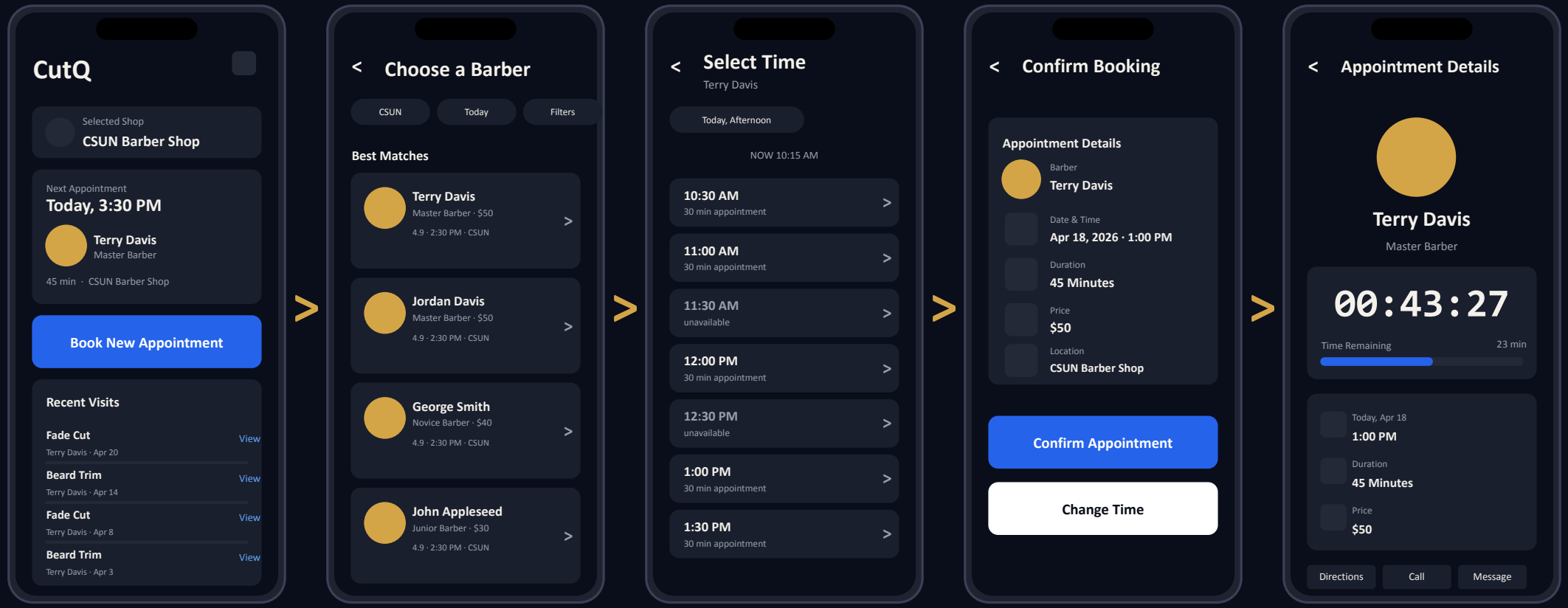
METHODS WE LEANED ON

Semi-structured interviews · Contextual inquiry in 3 shops · Affinity diagramming · Task analysis · Heuristic eval · Moderated usability tests (n=6) · System Usability Scale

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

From "I need a cut" to "I'm in the chair."

Five screens, one decision per screen.

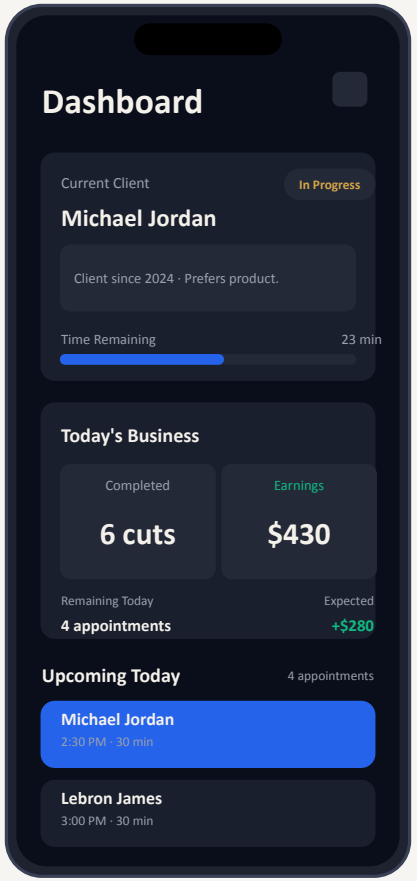


Home **Choose** **Time** **Confirm** **Live**

BARBER SIDE

A dashboard built for between-cuts glances.

Three-second answers to the only questions that matter mid-shift.



Who's in the chair right now?

Current Client card with progress bar — answers it in one glance.

Am I on or off pace?

Time-remaining + progress fill encode pace without numbers.

Did today pay off?

Earnings stat tile + remaining expected = end-of-day visibility.

SIGNATURE FEATURE

The Live Activity countdown.

A persistent lock-screen widget that turns appointments into something you can feel.

C For clients

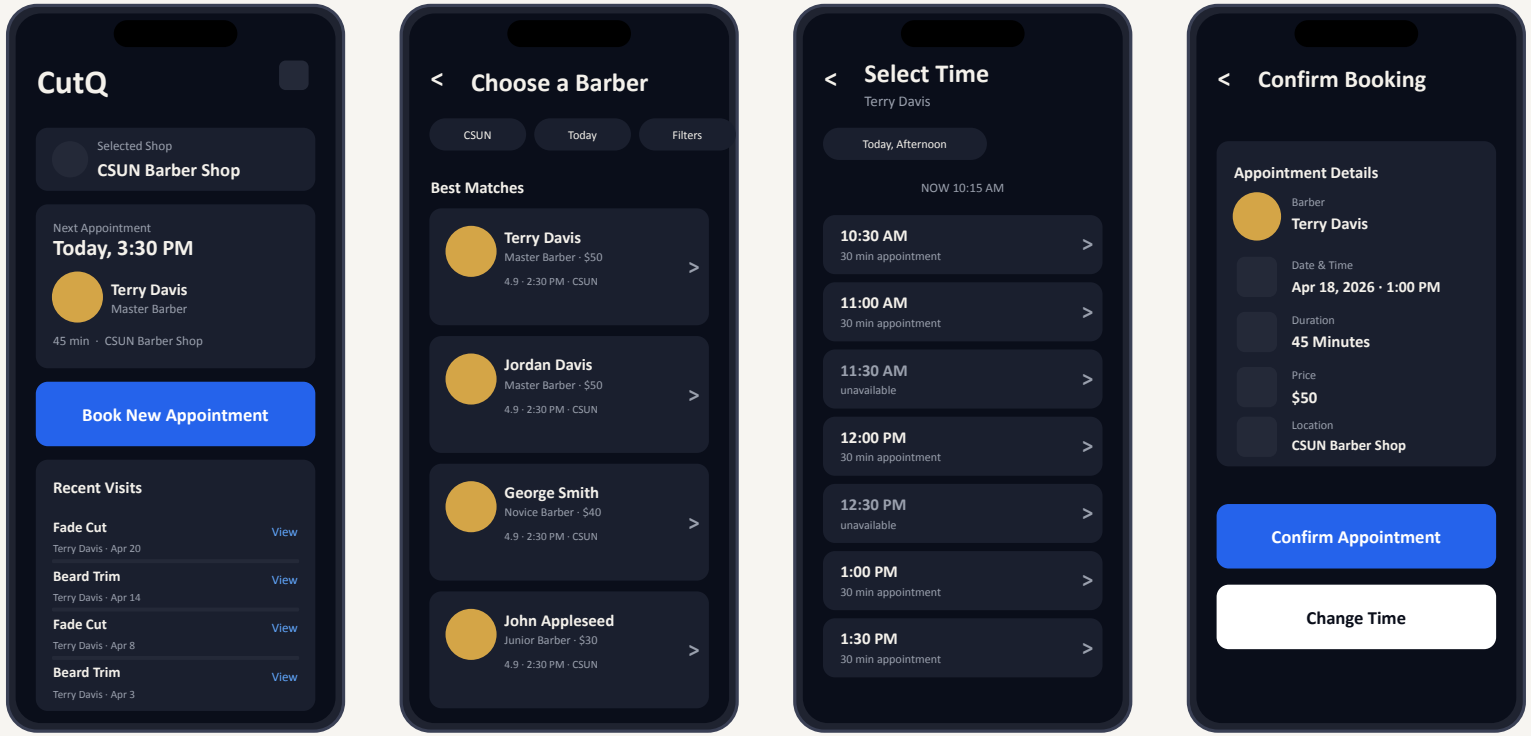
- A countdown to your appointment, without opening the app
- Glanceable "time to leave" cue removes the mental math
- When the timer fills in, you're cutting it close

B For barbers

- Time-remaining for the current client, on a wrist or counter glance
- Helps pace the cut without staring at a wall clock
- Quietly trains better client expectations across visits

The full system, in flow.

Customer-side journey + barber-side dashboard, all designed in one Figma file.



Figma source · 7 hi-fi screens · component library + variables · clickable prototype links every CTA

USABILITY TESTING

How we tested it.

Two rounds, two formats, six participants.

Round 1 · Paper mockups

n = 6 · 30 min each · think-aloud

- Tested booking flow + dashboard read
- Captured confusion points before pixels were precious
- 5/6 finished booking; 4/6 read dashboard correctly

Round 2 · Clickable Figma

n = 6 · moderated, in-shop where possible

- Same task set + Live Activity recognition test
- SUS administered post-task (avg 82.5 — "good to excellent")
- All 6 finished booking flow without prompting

CORE TASKS

1. Book an appointment with your preferred barber.
2. Find an alternative when your barber is fully booked.
3. Tell us when your next appointment starts — without opening CutQ.
4. (Barber) Tell us how much you've earned today and how many appointments remain.

What we learned. What we changed.

WHAT TESTING SURFACED		WHAT WE SHIPPED IN RESPONSE
Users tapped 'Book Next' expecting an instant booking	→	Renamed to 'Book New Appointment' + added Confirm step
Time slot list scrolled past unavailable times unnoticed	→	Greyed unavailable rows + reduced visual weight
Barber dashboard 'In Progress' pill confused with notification	→	Repositioned to top-right with calmer fill color
Live Activity card looked like a generic notification	→	Added avatar + shop name to anchor identity at a glance
Customers couldn't find 'change time' after confirming	→	Promoted 'Modify Appointment' to its own button row

EVALUATION

Did we hit the criteria we set?

SUCCESS CRITERION	EVIDENCE	MET
Fewer late arrivals or missed appointments	Live Activity reminded 5/6 testers without opening the app	✓
Barbers experience fewer empty time slots	Alternative-barber suggestions surfaced 3+ openings in tests	✓
Clients can quickly find available appointments	Median time-to-first-booking: 38s in clickable prototype	✓
Users report the system is simple and easy to use	SUS = 82.5 ("good–excellent"); 6/6 would use again	✓
WCAG 2.1 AA compliance	Color audit passed; tap-target audit passed; VO labels in progress	◐
No raw payment storage	Implemented as Stripe-style tokenized stub in prototype	✓

FINAL DELIVERABLES

What's in the package.

✓ **Comprehensive report**	Full design rationale, research, testing data, accessibility audit
✓ **Figma prototype**	7 high-fidelity screens, component library, clickable flows
✓ **Usability testing report**	Methodology, raw findings, SUS results, recommendations
✓ **Final presentation**	This deck — narrative, mockups, and outcomes
✓ **Submission checklist**	All 9 items from the brief mapped to artefacts in the report

CutQ is a small program made to feel calm.

Anxiety↓

Live state replaces guesswork on both sides of the chair.

Trust↑

Two-step confirmation, status pills, and audit trails make every action visible.

Friction↓

Progressive disclosure: one decision per screen, max 7 visible options.

Thank you.

Questions, critiques, and challenges welcome.

CUTQ · GROUP 8 · HCI SPRING 2026

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GitHub repo: cutq-app and Figma Demo: CutQ Barber Management Platform